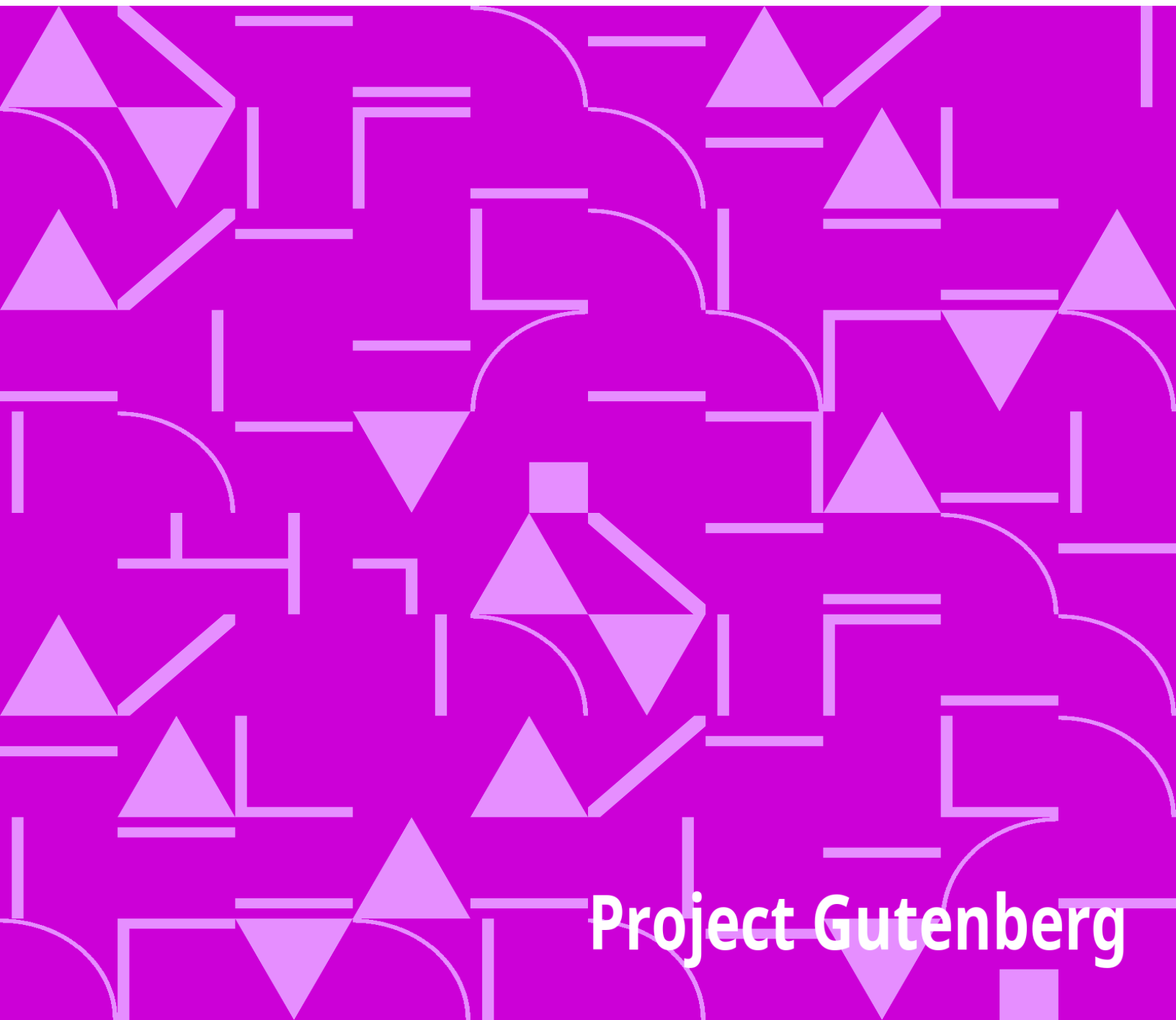


American Historical and Literary Curiosities, Part 13.

J. Jay Smith



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J. Jay Smith

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Title: American Historical and Literary Curiosities, Part 13.

Author: J. Jay Smith

Release date: July 15, 2004 [eBook #7913]

Most recently updated: December 30, 2020

Language: English

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HISTORICAL AND LITERARY CURIOSITIES, PART 13. ***

**AMERICAN HISTORICAL
AND
LITERARY CURIOSITIES**

By John Jay Smith

Part 13.

Second Series

1860

AMERICAN
Historical and Literary Curiosities;
CONSISTING OF
Fac-Similes of some Plates, &c. Relating to
COLUMBUS,
AND
ORIGINAL DOCUMENTS of the REVOLUTION,
&c. &c.

WITH A VARIETY OF RELIQUES, ANTIQUITIES, AND AUTOGRAPHS.

EDITED AND ARRANGED,
WITH THE ASSISTANCE OF SEVERAL AUTOGRAPH COLLECTORS,

BY

JOHN JAY SMITH,
MEMBER OF THE HISTORICAL SOCIETY OF PENNSYLVANIA, ETC.

SECOND SERIES—COMPLETE IN ITSELF.

NEW YORK:
CHARLES B. RICHARDSON.
1860.

Enlarge

PREFACE.

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It may be proper to copy here a portion of the Preface to the fifth edition of the First Series, explanatory of the object of the work:—

"The past has a charm for Americans, as well as for the inhabitants of countries whose history extends far into the shadowy and unknown. *Our* early and romantic past has the merit of being known and truly related. Every thing which adds to these truths is sought for with avidity by the curious and intelligent inquirer. We have now many autograph-collectors, who may be viewed in the light of preservers of documents which would otherwise perish or be dispersed. To few, comparatively, are their treasures revealed. It was suggested, therefore, that some of the most rare 'Historical and Literary Curiosities' in the possession of individuals, should be grouped for the amusement and instruction of the present and of future generations, who may well know from printed accounts *what* things were done, but who can also thus learn *how* they were done."

As in the First Series, nearly all the articles in the present collection have been taken by competent artists from the originals of which they purport to be fac-similes. Considerable labor and trouble have been expended in collecting together and adapting the varied materials here presented, but I have been rewarded by the pleasure of the pursuit.

JOHN JAY SMITH.

* * Fully to understand the work, it is necessary, in turning over the pages, to have constant reference to the Tables of Contents, where will be found many explanations for which there was not space on the plates.

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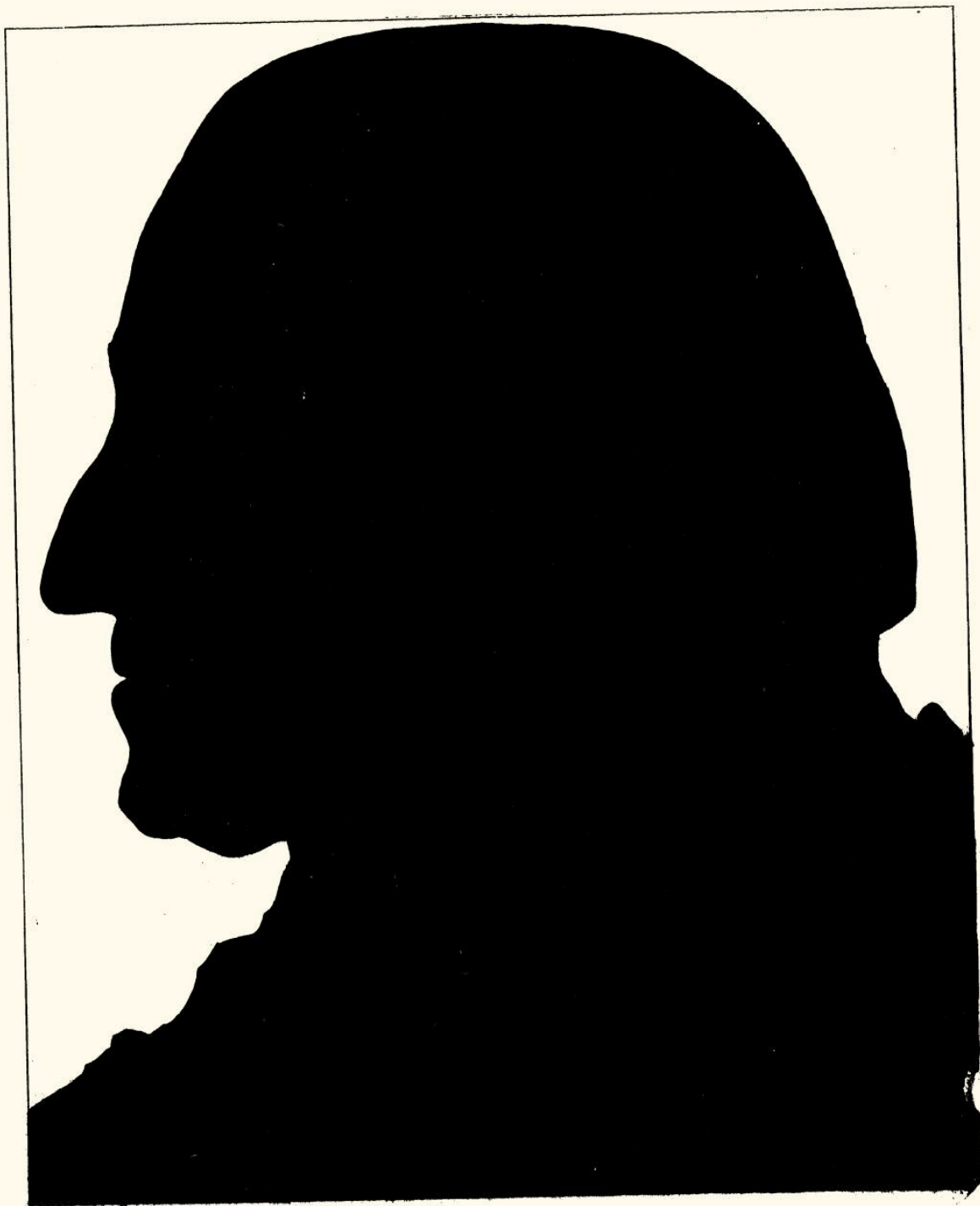
[Plate 16.](#)

[Plate 17.](#)

[Plate 18.](#)

[Plate 19.](#)

[Plate 20.](#)



G. Washington

Enlarge

LETTER FROM GENERAL WASHINGTON

TO

FRANCIS HOPKINSON, Esq.

MOUNT VERNON, May 16, 1785.

DEAR SIR :

“In for a penny, in for a pound,” is an old adage. I am so hackneyed to the touches of the painter’s pencil, that I am *now* altogether at their beck, and sit like Patience on a monument, whilst they are delineating the lines of my face.

It is a proof among many others of what habit and custom can effect. At first I was as impatient at the request, and as restive under the operation, as a colt is of the saddle. The next time, I submitted very reluctantly, but with less of flouncing. Now no dray moves more readily to the thill than I do to the painter’s chair. It may easily be conceived, therefore, that I yielded a ready obedience to your request and to the views of Mr. Pine.

Letters from England, recommendatory of this gentleman, came to my hand previous to his arrival in America,—not only as an artist of acknowledged eminence, but as one who had discovered a friendly disposition to this country, for which it seems he had been marked.

It gave me pleasure to hear from you. I shall always feel an interest in your happiness ; and, with Mrs. Washington’s compliments and best wishes joined to my own, for Mrs. Hopkinson and yourself,

I am,

Dear Sir,

Your most obedt and affecte^d hble servant,

GO. WASHINGTON.

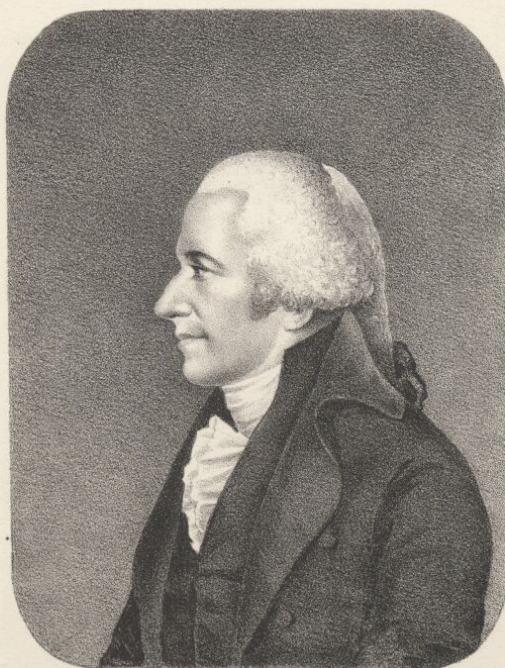
FRANCIS HOPKINSON, Esq.

Enlarge



G Washington

Miniature of Washington on Ivory
by Mrs. Sharpless.



*Y friend Gen
Hamilton
A.D.C*

Miniature of Alexander Hamilton on Ivory

my dear Jenny New York October 22^d 1889

I have by Mrs. Sims sent you a watch - it is one of the cages that I have so long mentioned to you, that was expected, I hope is such a one as will please you - it is of the newest fashion, & that has any influence on you - the chain is of soft steel, choosing and such as Mrs. Adams the vice president's lady and those in the police circle wear.

Mrs. Sims will give you a better account of the fashion than I can - I have a very full life here and know nothing that happens in the town - I never go to any public place - indeed I think I am more like a state prisoner than any thing else, there is certain bounds set for me which I must not depart from - and as I cannot do as I like I am obstinate and stay at home a great deal.

The President set out this day week on a tour to the eastward Mr. Dear and Major Jackson attended him - my dear children has had very bad colds but thank God they are getting better - my love and good wishes attend you and all with you - remember me to Mr & Mrs L. W. Now is the time child - keep Maria & send her the little handkerchiefs I wrote her now adue

I am my dear Jane my yours

most affectionately

M. Washington

Enlarge

Mount Vernon Jan 31st 1783.

Sir,

The interruption of the Post by the frost, withheld your letter of the 31st ult^o from me until within a few days.

The liberty you have taken in dedicating your Poetical Works to me, does me honor — The conditions upon which you offer them to the Public are generous — evincing of their parity and conscious worth. — I shall with my pleasure therefore take a few copies of the bound & lettered Books, when they are ready for delivery.

It behoves me to correct a mistake in your printed address "To the patrons of the fine arts." I am the Marshall of France — nor do I hold any Commission, or fill any Office under that Government — or any other whatever. — I am — Sir
Y^r most obed^t & devoted

M^{rs} Abigail Lament

G. Washington

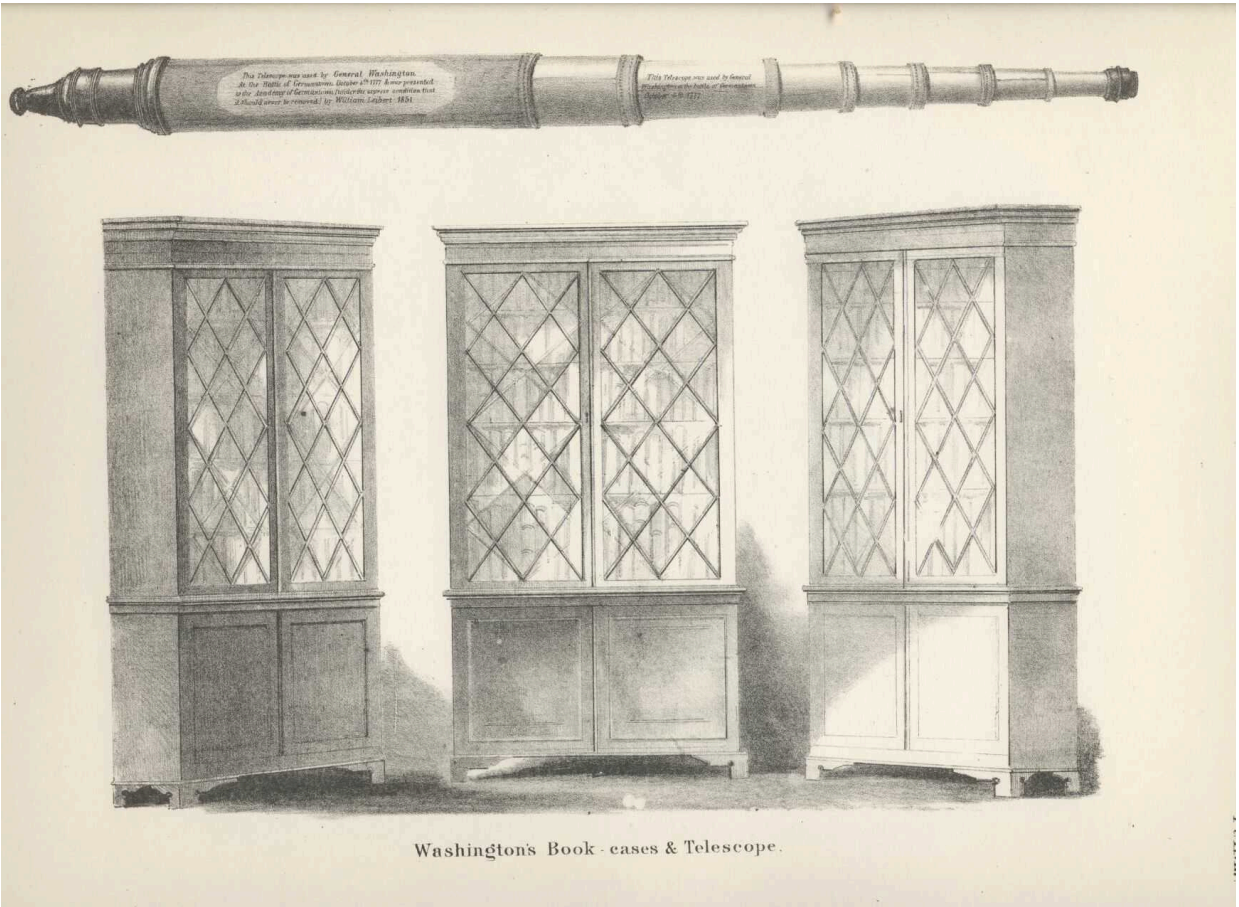
Frank of
PRESIDENT WASHINGTON
April 28th 1789

Clement Biddle Esquire.

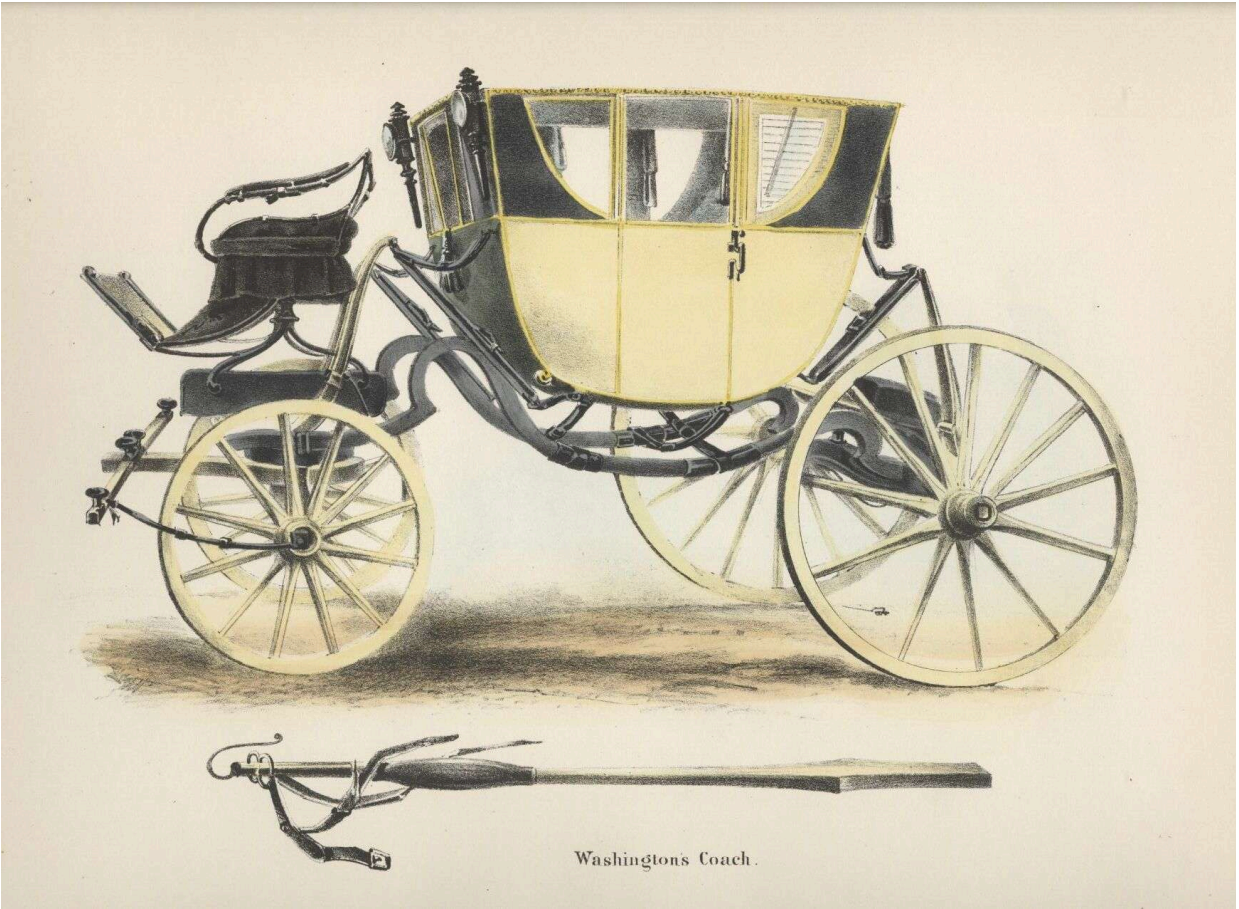
President
U. S.

Philadelphia

Enlarge



Enlarge



Washingtons Coach.

Enlarge

Bps. consecrated by me - Wm. White,

1795. Sep. 14 ----- Rev Robert Smith. D.D.
 ---7--- May --- Edward Bass. D.D.
 --- Oct. 10 --- Abraham Jarvis D.D.
 1801. Sep. 11 ----- Benj. Moore D.D.
 ---4. Sep. 14 ----- Sam. Parker D.D.
 ---11. May 20 ----- John H. Hobart D.D.
 ----- Alex. S. Geiswold.
 ---12. Oct. 15 ----- Theodore Dehon D.D.
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 ---15. Nov. 19 ----- John Cress D.D.
 ---18 Oct. 8 ----- Nathaniel Bowditch
 ---19. Feb 11 ----- Philander Chase
 --- Oct. 27 ----- Thomas L. Brownell D.D.
 ---23. May 22. ----- John Stark Ravenscroft D.D.
 ---27. Oct. 25 ----- Henry W. Orendon D.D.
 ---29 Aug. 19. ----- Rev Wm. Meade. D.D.
 ---30. Oct. 21 ----- Rev Wm. Murray Stone D.D.
 --- Nov. 26 ----- Rev Benjamin Fredwell Orendonk D.D.
 ---31. Sep. 22. ----- Rev Levi Filliman D.D.
 ---32. Oct. 31 ----- Rev John H. Hopkins. D.D.
 ----- Rev Benj. B. Smith, D.D.
 ----- Rev Charles S. McHargue D.D.
 ----- Rev George W. Doane. D.D.
 34. Jan. 14 ----- Rev James H. Otey. D.D.
 35. Sep. 25 ----- Rev Jackson Kemper D.D.

Bishops consecrated by Bishop White.

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NEW YORK:
CHARLES B. RICHARDSON.
1860.

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PREFACE.

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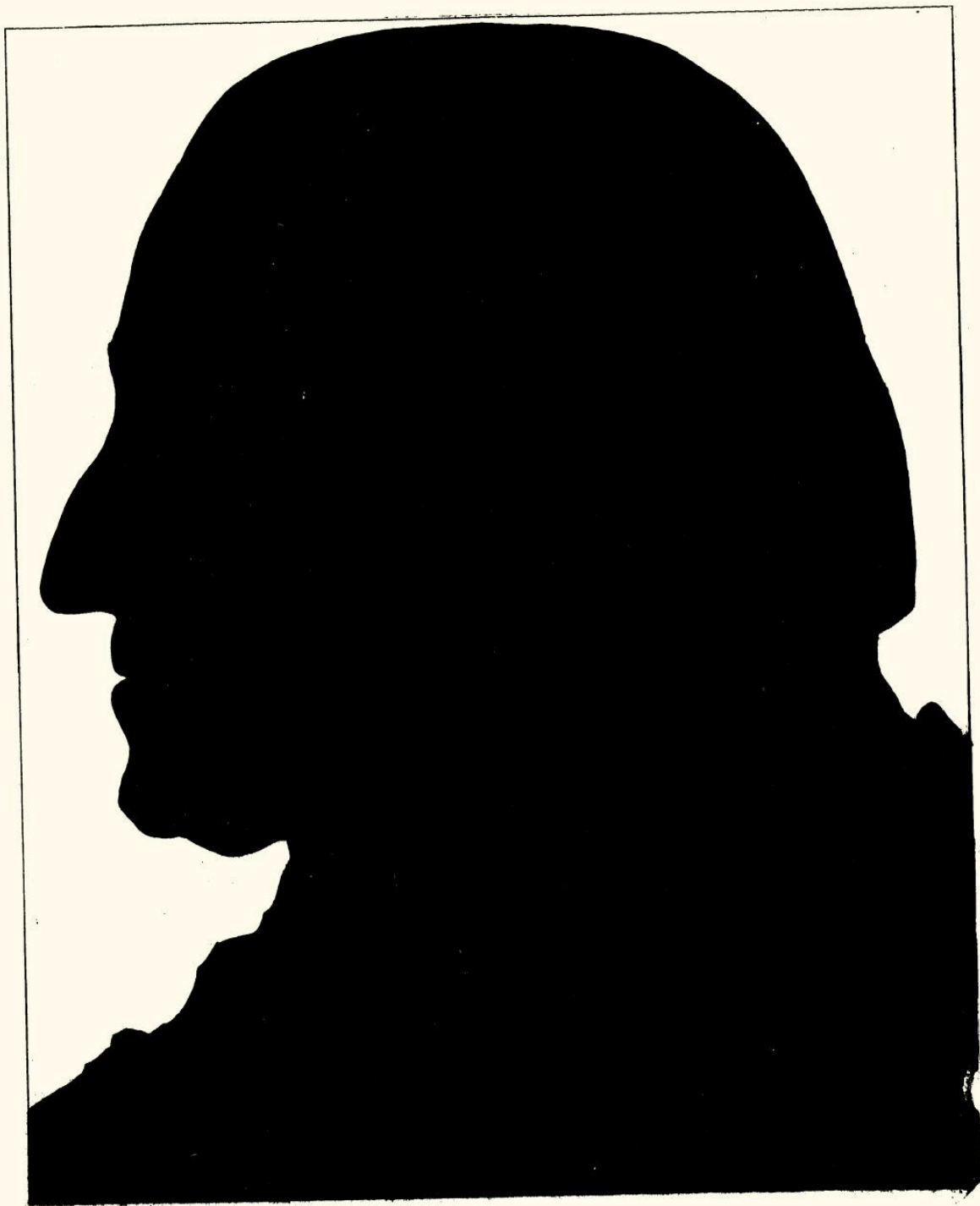
It may be proper to copy here a portion of the Preface to the fifth edition of the First Series, explanatory of the object of the work:—

"The past has a charm for Americans, as well as for the inhabitants of countries whose history extends far into the shadowy and unknown. *Our* early and romantic past has the merit of being known and truly related. Every thing which adds to these truths is sought for with avidity by the curious and intelligent inquirer. We have now many autograph-collectors, who may be viewed in the light of preservers of documents which would otherwise perish or be dispersed. To few, comparatively, are their treasures revealed. It was suggested, therefore, that some of the most rare 'Historical and Literary Curiosities' in the possession of individuals, should be grouped for the amusement and instruction of the present and of future generations, who may well know from printed accounts *what* things were done, but who can also thus learn *how* they were done."

As in the First Series, nearly all the articles in the present collection have been taken by competent artists from the originals of which they purport to be fac-similes. Considerable labor and trouble have been expended in collecting together and adapting the varied materials here presented, but I have been rewarded by the pleasure of the pursuit.

JOHN JAY SMITH.

* * Fully to understand the work, it is necessary, in turning over the pages, to have constant reference to the Tables of Contents, where will be found many explanations for which there was not space on the plates.



G. Washington

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LETTER FROM GENERAL WASHINGTON

TO

FRANCIS HOPKINSON, Esq.

MOUNT VERNON, May 16, 1785.

DEAR SIR :

“In for a penny, in for a pound,” is an old adage. I am so hackneyed to the touches of the painter’s pencil, that I am *now* altogether at their beck, and sit like Patience on a monument, whilst they are delineating the lines of my face.

It is a proof among many others of what habit and custom can effect. At first I was as impatient at the request, and as restive under the operation, as a colt is of the saddle. The next time, I submitted very reluctantly, but with less of flouncing. Now no dray moves more readily to the thill than I do to the painter’s chair. It may easily be conceived, therefore, that I yielded a ready obedience to your request and to the views of Mr. Pine.

Letters from England, commendatory of this gentleman, came to my hand previous to his arrival in America,—not only as an artist of acknowledged eminence, but as one who had discovered a friendly disposition to this country, for which it seems he had been marked.

It gave me pleasure to hear from you. I shall always feel an interest in your happiness ; and, with Mrs. Washington’s compliments and best wishes joined to my own, for Mrs. Hopkinson and yourself,

I am,

Dear Sir,

Your most obedt and affecte hble servant,

GO. WASHINGTON.

FRANCIS HOPKINSON, Esq.

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my dear Jenny New York October 22^d 1879

I have by Mrs. Sims sent you a watch - it is one of the cages that I have so long mentioned to you, that was expected, I hope is such a one as will please you - it is of the newest fashion, of that has any influence on you - the chain is of soft steel, choosing and such as Mrs. Adams the vice president's lady and those in the public circle wear.

Mrs. Sims will give you a better account of the fashions than I can - I have a very full life here and know nothing that happens in the town - I never go to any public place - indeed I think I am more like a state prisoner than any thing else, there is certain bounds set for me which I must not depart from - and as I cannot do as I like I am obstinate and stay at home a great deal.

The President set out this day week on a tour to the eastward Mr. Dear and Major Jackson attended him - my dear children has had very bad colds but thank God they are getting better - my love and good wishes attend you and all with you - remember me to Mr & Mrs L. W. how is the poor child - keep him warm & send her the little handkerchiefs I wrote her some adieu I am my dear Jane my yours

most affectionately
M. Washington

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Mount Vernon Jan 31st 1783.

Sir,

The interruption of the Post by the frost, withheld your letter of the 31st ult^o from me until within a few days.

The liberty you have taken in dedicating your Poetical Works to me, does me honor — The conditions upon which you offer them to the Public are generous — evincing of their parity and conscious worth. — I shall with my pleasure therefore take a few copies of the bound & lettered Books, when they are ready for delivery.

It behoves me to correct a mistake in your printed address "To the patrons of the fine arts." I am the Marshall of France — nor do I hold any Commission, or fill any Office under that Government — or any other whatever. — I am — Sir
Y^r most obed^t & devoted

M^{rs} Anne's Lament

G. Washington

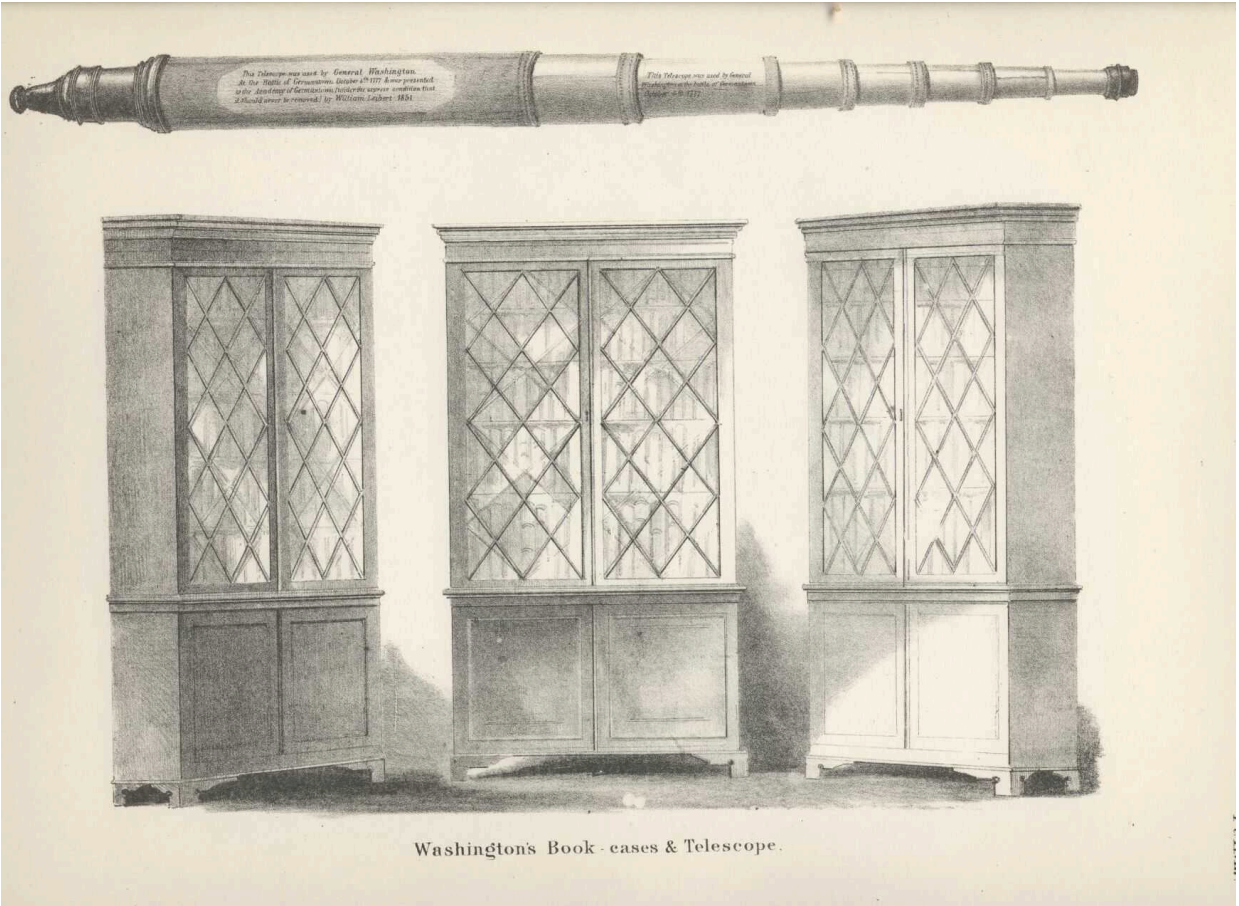
Frank of
PRESIDENT WASHINGTON
April 28th 1789

Clement Biddle Esquire?

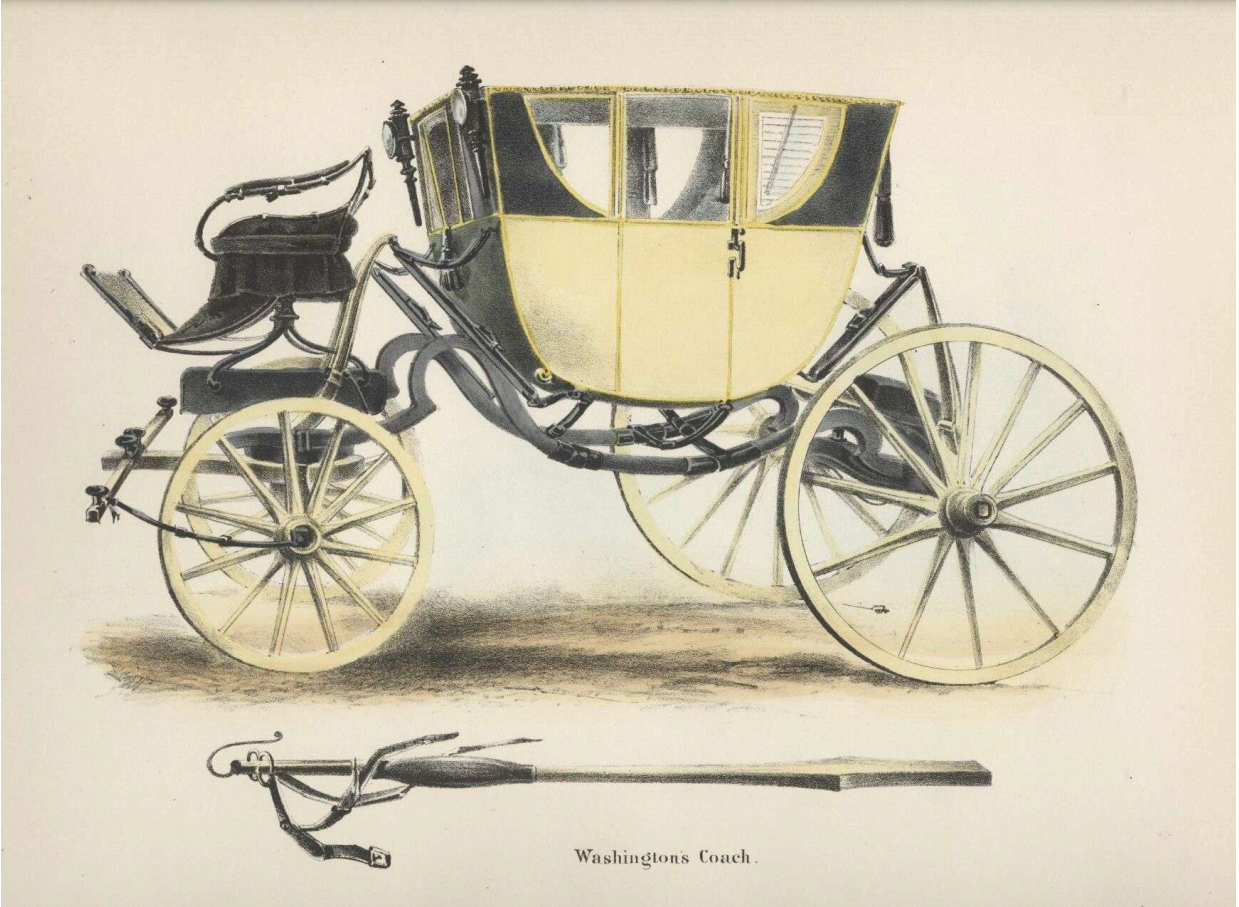
Resident
U. S.

Philadelphia

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Washingtons Coach.

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Bps. consecrated by me - Wm. White,

1795. Sep. 14 ----- Rev Robert Smith. D.D.
 ---7--- May --- Edward Bass. D.D.
 --- Oct. 10 --- Abraham Jarvis D.D.
 1801. Sep. 11 ----- Benj. Moore D.D.
 ---4. Sep. 14 ----- Sam. Parker D.D.
 ---11. May 20 ----- John H. Hobart D.D.
 ----- Alex. S. Geiswold.
 ---12. Oct. 15 ----- Theodore Dehon D.D.
 ---14. May 10 ----- Richard Channing Moore D.D.
 --- Sep. 1 ----- James Henshaw D.D.
 ---15. Nov. 19 ----- John Cress D.D.
 ---18 Oct. 8 ----- Nathaniel Bowditch
 ---19. Feb 11 ----- Philander Chase
 --- Oct. 27 ----- Thomas L. Brownell D.D.
 ---23. May 22. ----- John Stark Ravenscroft D.D.
 ---27. Oct. 25 ----- Henry W. Orendonk D.D.
 ---29 Aug. 19. ----- Rev Wm. Meade. D.D.
 ---30. Oct. 21 ----- Rev Wm. Murray Stone D.D.
 --- Nov. 26 ----- Rev Benjamin Redwell Orendonk D.D.
 ---31. Sep. 22. ----- Rev Levi Filliman D.D.
 ---32. Oct. 31 ----- Rev John H. Hopkins. D.D.
 ----- Rev Benj. B. Smith, D.D.
 ----- Rev Charles S. McHargue D.D.
 ----- Rev George W. Doane. D.D.
 34. Jan. 14 ----- Rev James H. Otey. D.D.
 35. Sep. 25 ----- Rev Jackson Kemper D.D.

Bishops consecrated by Bishop White.

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